

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DCCED

Date: 5/14/2026

Bill Number: HB 244

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): CNA Training

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☐ SIGN ☐ VETO ☒ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

This legislation is unnecessary because the Board of Nursing already agreed to make the changes to the certified nurse aide (CNA) training requirements in regulation. However, the regulations have not yet gone through since this change was part of their AO 360 regulatory reform project. (We just received approval to begin submitting projects on the regulatory reform plan to Department of Law.) The lack of progress on the regulatory change led the legislature to move forward with this statutory change. However, we think it'd be fine to just let it become law without signing since it doesn't have any negative impact, aside from putting more specificity in statute than is necessary.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

HB 244 defines, in statute, what the CNA regulations must require of a training program, including effective communication skills, care, and basic knowledge of Alzheimer's disease, dementia, dementia-related behaviors, mental illness, intellectual disabilities, or other cognitive

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disabilities/impairments.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1 Adds a new subsection (c) to AS 08.68.331 – *Nursing: certification of nurse aides* – to require regulations adopted by the Board of Nursing which set the standards for a certified nurse aide (CNA) training program to require the program ensure clients receive safe and competent care and train a CNA to:

- Form a relationship, communicate, and interact competently with a client;
- Demonstrate sensitivity to emotional, social, and mental health needs of a client through skillful and directed interactions;
- Assist a client in reaching and maintaining independence;
- Support and promote a client’s rights;
- Demonstrate skills observing and monitoring a client during caregiving, and reporting those observations to enable the assessment of the client;
- Problem-solve when providing care;
- Ensure and preserve the respect, values, choices, and dignity of a client;
- Demonstrate knowledge of client assessment and care planning best practices;
- Use effective communication skills, including while communicating with a client with psychosocial needs or Alzheimer's disease, dementia, a mental illness, an intellectual disability, or another cognitive disability or impairment;
- Provide care to a client who is cognitively impaired or has a decline in cognitive functions related to dementia; and
- Demonstrate basic knowledge of Alzheimer’s disease, dementia, dementia-related behaviors, and activities of daily living (defined as eating, dressing, grooming, bathing, and toileting).

Section 2 Provides a July 1, 2026, effective date.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

Companion – SB 103 by Senator Gray-Jackson

Riders – none

Amendments – none

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support

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or in opposition of this bill.

Support:

- Alaska Nurses Association (AaNA), Shannon Davenport, MSN, BSN, RN, AaNA President, shannon@aknurse.org, (907) 274-0827
- Alzheimer's Association – Alaska Chapter, (800) 272-3900

Opposition:

- None

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

N/A – we'd recommend LWOS so no billing signing necessary.

Commissioner's Signature:  Date: 5/21/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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